

Weekly Progress Report

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Domain: Prompt Engineering

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Week Ending: 01

I. Overview:

This week, the primary focus was on completing the core modules of the Prompt Engineering course. I focused on understanding how Large Language Models (LLMs) interpret inputs and explored various prompting techniques to improve the accuracy and relevance of AI-generated responses.

II. Achievements:

1. Prompt Engineering Fundamentals:

- Completed the introductory modules covering the history and mechanics of LLMs.
- Learned the "Structure of a Prompt," including Instructions, Context, Input Data, and Output Indicators.

2. Technique Mastery:

- Practiced **Zero-shot** and **Few-shot prompting** to guide models with and without examples.
- Explored **Chain-of-Thought (CoT)** prompting to help models break down complex reasoning tasks step-by-step.

3. Hands-on Application:

- Successfully executed prompts for text summarization, data extraction, and creative writing.
- Applied "Delimiters" (like triple quotes or XML tags) to clearly separate instructions from user content.

III. Challenges:

1. Prompt Sensitivity:

- Encountered challenges where slight changes in wording led to significantly different (and sometimes incorrect) outputs.
- Ongoing effort to learn "Prompt Tuning" to minimize model hallucinations.

2. Context Window Management:

- Faced complexity in keeping prompts concise while providing enough context for the model to follow instructions accurately.

IV. Learning Resources:

1. Course Modules:

- Utilized the provided "Prompt Engineering" curriculum and video lectures on the upSkill Campus portal.

2. Official Documentation:

- Referenced OpenAI and Anthropic documentation for best practices in prompt design.
- Engaged with community forums to see real-world examples of "jailbreaking" and "prompt injection" prevention.

V. Next Week's Goals:

1. Advanced Frameworks:

- Start exploring advanced frameworks like the **CREATE** or **RTF** (Role, Task, Format) framework.

2. Project Commencement:

- Select a specific project from the portal list and begin building a custom prompt library for a specific use case (e.g., Customer Support Bot or Code Assistant).

VI. Additional Comments:

The course provided a solid foundation. I observed that the effectiveness of an AI model is almost entirely dependent on the quality of the prompt, making this skill vital for future project development.